



March
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Chinmaya Sakshi



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Chinmaya International Residential School

From the Editor's Desk

Hari Om ,

The month of March brings with it the beginning of a new phase. The 12th graders and 10th graders of our school are taking the Board exams, and are marking either their transition from 10th to 11th or from 12th to college. For the 12th, it is the time to depart from our school, and that is in no way an easy thing to do. Some of them have been with the Chinmaya family since 5th or 6th standard, literally growing up at CIRS. The 10th graders also are now entering their crucial pre-college years, wherein they will decide their majors and channelize their energies towards the plans they have set for the future. Either way, it is a big change for students of both grades. This month is also a transition period for the whole CIRS family as its time for promotion for all classes. The end of the month showed the beginning of our Shubh Sahas learning program.

With regards,

Gautam Pathial, Shruti Kedia, Vishwanth Kumar, and Savi Kerkar
The Cultural and Literary Secretaries



Khel Mela 2008



CIRS conducted their annual sports day, *Khel Mela*, in the first week of February. The school emerged with sports achievers, enthusiastic students; and during the Khel Mela time, CIRS bubbled with energy.

All houses were at work, with only one objective in mind: to win the house championship. The CIRS family worked tirelessly day and night, to make this mega event possible.

On 5th Feb., our school gates opened to welcome the proud parents of our school. With that evening the events started with a whole evening dedicated to them. Several events took place, exclusively for our parents, grandparents and our siblings such as volley ball, cricket, and walk-a-thon, races and many more. They were more thrilled and enthusiastic than students. It felt as if they were transported back to their childhood days.

The next day started with March past where we saluted our chief guest, **R.Natarajan**, superintendent of customs Dept., Chennai and **Dr. K.Vaithianathan**, Prof. and Director, Dept. of Phy.Edu. and Sports Sci., Annamalai University.

This event was followed by a series of field and track events. Following this, we had our CIRS Annual Aquatic meet where our swimmers showed off their skill, followed by lunch.



Khel Mela 2008



After rest, the family reunited to witness a spectacular sight of our drills, ranging from lezium to sword to fire drill. The drills performed by our students took us to the colorful city of Marathas to the fierce and bold Rajputs. This was followed by the much awaited, 'Inter- house drill competition'. The house drills was a splendid job done by our students. They ranged from Valmiki house's *dupatta and cap drill in a smiley performance* to Vishwamitra house's '*fight drill*', with a series of exercises that were creatively presented as a fight between two armies. The Vashistha house choose pompoms (for girls) and poles (for boys) and the house aligned itself in a *swastic formation* and the Vyasa house performed a marvelous drill with the help of hoops and bamboo dance which eventually made these houses(Vasishtha and Vyasa house) get the best house drill cup.

This was followed by a prize distribution ceremony were the sport archives of CIRS were felicitated. At last, with this we came to an end of our 12th Annual Athletic and Aquatic Meet. Following are the winners of various events of Khel mela,





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Following are the winners of various events of Khel mela,

- Best march past** - **Valmiki House**
- Best Individual Activities** - **Vasishtha and Vishwamitra House**
- Best Drill** - **Vyasa House**
- Over all Championship** - **Valmiki House**

Outstanding Sports Person		
Sr. No.	Name	House
1	Soham Desai	Vishwamitra

Best National Players		
Sr. No.	Name	House
1	Dhiaan	Vyasa
2	Vasudev	Valmiki

Cross Country			
Sr. No.	Category	Name	House
1	Junior - Boys	Ketan	Vasishtha
2	Junior - Boys	Prasant	Valmiki
3	Junior - Girls	Aneshaa S.	Vasishtha
4	Junior - Girls	Narmadha	Vishwamitra
5	Senior - Girls	Mowthi K.	Vyasa



BEST PLAYERS OF CIRS

S.No	Game	Names						
1	Tennis	Arun Aditya	Akkash G.	Devika C.	Raj Mandalia			
2	Table Tennis	Nikhil Sharma	Ratik Saboo	Jenil Gogri	Darshana			
3	Cricket	Soham Desai	Kunal Desai	Rounak C.	Shivankar A.			
4	Badminton	Sanket Sahoo	Ashok Niranjana	Nanthitha S.	Lakshmi Sneha			
5	Hockey	Sentil Kumar	Jyoti Vishankar	Bhishma	Shruti Kedia	Prachi K.		
6	Athletics	Ritika Khemka	Jayanthi M.	R. Roshini	Rounak C.	Abhinav Gupta		
7	Basket ball	Sharanya R.	Aishwarya S.	Vidisha S.	Varun	Devnarayan	Anirudh D.	
8	Foot ball	Dhiaana S.S.	Vasudev P.	Vivek Kumar	Sagar Jamnal	Raman S.	S. Pavitra	Aishwarya M.
9	Swimming	Harsh T.	Ashish	Vineet	Mahesh	Nivetha T.	Narmadha U.	Aditi K.
		Shreya Gupta	Aishwarya M.					

INDIVIDUAL CHAMPIONS:

Annual Aquatic meet			
Sr. No.	Category	Name	House
1	5th Boys	Shantanu	Vishwamitra
2	Sub-Juniors -Boys	Shantanu	Vishwamitra
3	Junior -Boys	Ashish	Vishwamitra
4	Senior -Boys	S. Goutham	Vasishtha
5	Sup-Senior -Boys	Harsh T.	Vishwamitra
6	5th Girls	Aditi K.	Vishwamitra
7	Sub-Juniors -Girls	Aditi K.	Vishwamitra
8	Junior -Girls	Uma A.	Valmiki
9	Senior -Girls	Aishwarya M.	Valmiki
10	Sup-Senior -Girls	Devika C.	Vyasa
Annual Atheletic Meet			
Sr. No.	Category	Name	House
1	5th Boys	Aravind M.	Valmiki
2	Sub-Juniors -Boys	Abhishek	Vishwamitra
3	Junior -Boys	Vasudev Parkkot	Valmiki
4	Senior -Boys	Dhiaana	Vyasa
5	Sup-Senior -Boys	Soham Desai	Vishwamitra
6	5th Girls	Aditi K.	Vishwamitra
7	Sub-Juniors -Girls	Shreenika	Vyasa
8	Sub-Juniors -Girls	Manisha	Valmiki
9	Junior -Girls	Aishwarya S.	Valmiki
10	Senior -Girls	Nanthitha	Valmiki
11	Sup-Senior -Girls	Sharanya	Vasishtha
12	Sup-Senior -Girls	Devika C.	Vyasa

IAF WORKSHOP



The **Indian Air Force** (IAF) is the air-wing of the Armed Forces of India and has the prime responsibility of conducting aerial warfare and securing the Indian airspace. With its headquarters in New Delhi, the IAF has a strength of approximately 170,000 personnel and 1,350 combat aircraft (2006 figure) making it the fourth largest air force in the world.

Our school had the opportunity to invite Wing Commander Bijlani, Captain Abhisekh and their team for an interactive workshop with the senior school students comprising of grades 11 and grade 12. The motive for the workshop was not recruitment but was, to spread awareness about the air wing of our nation. The workshop informed us about the insights of the working of an air base camp.

The workshop informed us about those brave air warriors who had given up their life for our country. We became aware about the various branches of the IAF, namely the technical branch, the ground duty officials and about the *surya kirans* of India. We also saw the different type of equipment used by them. Last but not the least; we got the opportunity to know about the various expeditions of Captain Abhisekh and also Wing Commander Bijlani.

We had an educative and a fun-filled workshop. All our doubts regarding the IAF were clarified and few of us were motivated to be amongst the air warriors of our nation in future.



MAHA SHIVARATRI



Maha Shivaratri Festival or the 'The Night of Shiva' is celebrated with devotion and religious fervor in honor of Lord Shiva, one of the deities of the Hindu Trinity. Celebrating the festival of Shivaratri devotees observe day and night fast and perform ritual worship of Shiva Lingam to appease Lord Shiva.

In CIRS, we celebrated "MahaShivratri: The Night of Shiva" differently. We began this auspicious day with a homan to invoke the blessings of Lord. We were informed

about the legends regarding this festival. Few of our students observed a strict fast on this day. Some devotees did not even take a drop of water and they keep vigil all night.

In the evening we went to CORD (Chinmaya Organization for Rural Development), performed the abhisekha of the lord. The whole evening we chanted lord's name and rejoiced in his glory. This was followed by the abhisheka of the 'Shiva Linga' with water, milk and flowers.

HOLI



Holi, also called the Festival of Colours, is a popular Hindu spring festival observed in India. Holi is the festival that carries India and its people into the bright days of summer. A feeling of plenty is in the air with crops being cut, and the farmer enjoying a bountiful of harvest.

We celebrated holi with great joy. On 22nd march, bonfires were lit at night to signify burning the demon Holika, Hiranyakaship's sister. On this day we rejoice in the devotion of a devotee, Prahlad, towards Lord Narayana.

The next day, known as *Dhulhendi*, the CIRS family spent the day throwing colour powder (gulal) at each other. We enjoyed the morning with our friends and teachers and played with them all day long. We were provided with special lunch and snacks that day. We also had a special aarti that evening where we were lost in devotion and a few of our students also performed dance in his love.





William Shakespeare once said, “Farewell, fair cruelty.” This statement holds true for our XII CBSE grade. On the eve of 19th February, our beloved XII grades were bid farewell by the 11 grade, on behalf of the school. The theme for the evening was “Lights! Camera! Action!” The evening was setup in the form of an Oscar award ceremony. There was glitter, glamour and gold; and the stars of the evening were our outgoing students.

The hosts of the ceremony, the 11 grade were all setup in a retro style. The event began with a grand welcome of the stars of the evening, with Swamiji as our guest of honor, along with Anurag Sir, and all our teachers. The show began with a “movie- in- making”, with director, Mr. Ankit and producer, Mr. Gautam. The show kicked off with a few dance steps and a few scenes from the movie followed by a cake-cutting ritual by the class representatives of grade XII.

After that laugh riot, we had an award ceremony for our stars. Now, this ritual was also done intricately; a handmade wooden star (craved by 11 grade with the help of a saw and chisel), a CD consisting of a presentation in the memories of XII grade and a special award by the school.

This was followed by a series of talk given by our outgoing students and a few of our teachers. Their speeches moved us to tears. A special song was also sung by Grade 11 which drifted us to the fond memories of the past. With this we came to an end of our program with the final speech made by our dear Swamiji and Anurag Sir.

A special ceremony took place at the end the function. The out going students were requested to light a lamp, symbolizing knowledge, sacrifice and courage. They placed the lamp at any spot they chose on a large world map that was kept on the stage. When all the lamps were lit and kept lo, behold! The world was lighted up and looked just wonderful and beautiful. The outgoing students would all be the lights of the world in the time to come.





As the trend of our school continues we celebrated the science week dating from 18th February to the 23th February. Science is the subject which is applied in every field of education and life without science is like boat without oars.

Without knowing our surroundings, there is no use knowing the whole world. So the science week started with knowing our environment and conserving it. The presentation started with the situation of our school surrounded by water bodies. The Siruvani dam, the Noyyal and the river Bhavani are the water bodies which provide water to the city of Coimbatore. The river Noyyal is one of the most important water supplying source to the Coimbatore city and its surroundings. This river has been misused and has been polluted to a state that we have not been able to use the water resources in an appropriate manner. There have been many projects by environmentalists and the surrounding clubs of Coimbatore to clean up the river and make it suitable for proper usage. This was a beautiful presentation made by the science department which encouraged us not to litter and misuse our environment. Seeing our enthusiasm towards the environment our school conducted field trips to places like the Siruvani dam, science museum and some places in and around Coimbatore.

Space is one of the topics in science which we are amazed about but also doubtful. Space is a very vast topic to cover but taking the challenge our teachers made a presentation on Microcosms to Macrocosms.





This was a very interesting topic as most of the students did not know what this topic meant and what it was all about. The presentation was on magnifying the universe and then demagnifying it! This topic was indeed mind-blowing and was just a result of our imagination. The presentation started with a leaf. Then the camera was taken 10^1 meter away and a photograph was taken. Then 10^2 meters away and so on. This journey showed us our planet, solar system, galaxy. Where is the leaf? The universe is much massive than we can even think! Now we come back to the leaf and now we go the opposite way! First 10^{-1} then 10^{-2} metres and so on. We start magnifying the image. We start seeing the cells then the internal organelles of the cell then the molecules atoms and so on and so forth.

The junior science quiz was conducted during the science week. All the four houses participated enthusiastically giving a tough battle to each other. The quiz was conducted in the amphitheatre. The quiz was really interesting as there were facts given at the end of each and every round! But the best wins. The Vishwamitra house grabbed the first position in the quiz. The house did a very splendid job and took a small lead as all the houses were striving their best to reach the top!



1. The new senior school library in the I.B block has started functioning with the blessings of Gurudev and Swami Swaroopananda.
2. A few of our teachers went to Salem for the inauguration of the Salem Chinmaya Kaivalya ashram. Chinmaya Mission and Chinmaya Seva Trust have opened the Chinmaya Kaivalya ashram - a place for spiritual enlightenment.
3. In the beginning of the month of February, a Management workshop was conducted for the students of grade 11 and IB. This workshop was conducted by Mr. Suresh; the workshop taught the students about the different aspects of running a company such as marketing, production, manufacturing etc.
4. We got the opportunity to meet Dr. Kshama Metre, Dr. Didi as we fondly call her. Didi has been serving the mission since 43 years. She is the director of CORD (Chinmaya Organization for Rural Development) and she recently got a Padma Shri award. The senior school students had an interactive session with didi and learned a lot from her experiences.
5. Indian Ambassador Rajiv Bhatia visited our school and enriched us with his rich experiences. The senior school had the privilege to have an interactive session with him.
6. Gurudev's paduka pooja was organized for the outgoing 10th and 12th grades to invoke the blessings of Pujya Gurudev for their exams. The whole school participated in this pooja and prayed for their success.
7. Our 10th and 12th grades gave their board exams this March.
8. The Shubh Sahas program for the whole school began on 28th March.

